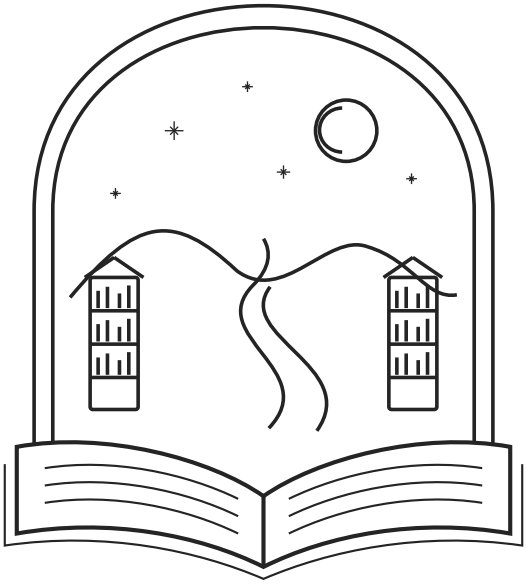
THE READING SOCIETY

The Book Club *Companion*

A place for good books
and longer conversations.



TWELVE GATHERINGS · UNDATED

START HERE

A simple reading ritual

BEFORE

Read at your own pace. Mark one passage, note one question and capture the impression you want to bring to the meeting.

TOGETHER

Use the suggested questions as starting points. Invite different readings, point to the text, and give everyone room to speak.

AFTER

Return to your first impression. Record what shifted, what stayed unresolved and what you would like to read next.

The twelve themes are optional lenses, not assignments. Fiction, memoir and narrative nonfiction can all fit. Replace any prompt that does not serve your book.

FIND YOUR PLACE

The gathering index

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GATHERING 01 / FIRST IMPRESSIONS

Before we meet

BOOK / AUTHOR

MEETING DATE / PLACE / HOST

ONE PASSAGE TO BRING · NOTE ITS PAGE

MY FIRST IMPRESSION

GATHERING 01 / FIRST IMPRESSIONS

My reading notes

Keep a detail, a tension or an idea. There is no need to write a complete review.

A VOICE, PERSON OR ARGUMENT I KEPT THINKING ABOUT

A THEME OR QUESTION BENEATH THE SURFACE

WHAT THE LANGUAGE OR STRUCTURE MADE ME NOTICE

GATHERING 01 / FIRST IMPRESSIONS

Questions for the table

Use these if they fit. Your own question belongs here too.

01 What did the opening teach you to expect, and did that expectation change?

02 Which moment first made the book feel distinctive?

03 What would you ask a reader who had a very different first impression?

A QUESTION OF OUR OWN

GATHERING 01 / FIRST IMPRESSIONS

Around the table

Record the ideas you want to remember, with the name of the reader who offered them.

A PERSPECTIVE THAT OPENED SOMETHING UP

A DISAGREEMENT WORTH KEEPING

A DETAIL WE RETURNED TO TOGETHER

GATHERING 01 / FIRST IMPRESSIONS

After the conversation

WHAT I SEE DIFFERENTLY NOW

WHAT I STILL WONDER

I WOULD RECOMMEND THIS BOOK TO… BECAUSE…